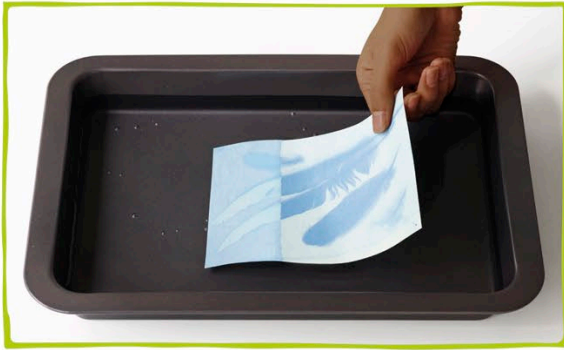


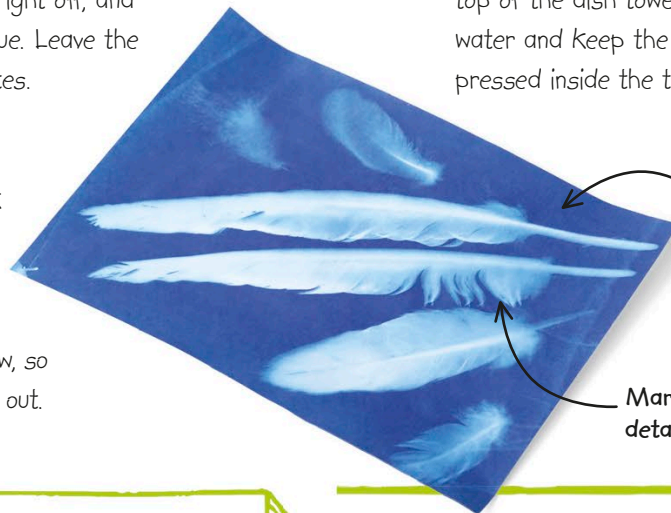


3 As quickly as you can, immerse the paper in the tray of water. You'll notice that the deep blue color of the feathers washes right off, and the pale blue areas turn darker blue. Leave the paper in the water for a few minutes.



4 To dry the paper, place it carefully in a clean, folded dish towel. Then put a heavy book on top of the dish towel, as this will help press out the water and keep the paper flat. Leave the paper pressed inside the towel for at least a few hours.

5 Unfold the dish towel to check the paper. If it's dry, your sun print is ready! You will see how the paper has changed color yet again. The blue areas are much darker now, so the white feather prints really stand out.



Ultraviolet light from the sun causes the compound Prussian blue to form.

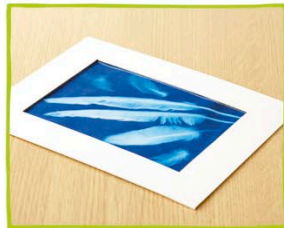
Marvel at the stunning detail of the feather prints.

TAKE IT FURTHER

Why not show off your beautiful sun prints to your friends and family in a sophisticated frame? All you need is a ruler, pencil, piece of card stock, glue, and scissors.



1 Using a ruler and sharp pencil, draw a rectangle on a thick piece of card stock. Make the rectangle slightly smaller than the sun print paper. Cut it out carefully.



2 Spread a generous amount of glue around the back of the frame, then stick on the sun print paper. Make sure you place it the right way up!

HOW IT WORKS

Light-sensitive paper is coated in chemicals that react together when they are exposed to a form of light called ultraviolet. This reaction causes a deep-blue compound, known as Prussian blue, to form on the paper. When the paper is put in water, the original chemicals—which remain in areas that sunlight hasn't reached—wash away, but Prussian blue stays on the paper.

REAL WORLD SCIENCE FRAGILE FLAG



If some materials are left in sunlight for a long time, ultraviolet light can damage them. So important museum objects, like this 200-year-old American flag, are often kept in dimly lit areas.